

Student Support Services Overview

Makerere University | Counselling, health, accommodation, meals and safety

Document type: Team-created summary (not an official university brochure). **Written from:** public Makerere University web pages listed in section 11. **Compiled:** 19 September 2026, for the 2026/2027 corpus of the University Student-Support Case Agent.

1. About this document

This overview brings together, in one place, the student support services that Makerere University describes on its public website. It is written in the team's own words. It covers counselling, health care, accommodation, meals and campus safety, and it points to other services that the university describes on separate pages. Details that change from year to year, such as phone numbers, hostel grades and hall capacity, are listed in section 10 so they can be re-checked.

2. Services at a glance

If the student needs	Go to	Contact or location
Personal, emotional or career support	Counselling and Guidance Centre	Manager: +256-772-558022. Counsellor: +256-784-107106 or +256-704-141386.
Medical care	Makerere University Hospital (part of Makerere University Health Services)	+256-414-541577 or +256-414-542922. Bativa Road, off Gaddafi Road, Kampala.
Hall allocation, hostel placement, welfare	Office of the Dean of Students	Senate Building, Room 208. dos.mak.ac.ug
Meals on campus	University food courts (six)	See section 6.
Reporting a crime or a safety concern	Campus Security and the Makerere University Police Station	Chief Security Officer: +256-772-329956. OC Station: +256-782-151656.
Course registration or documents	College or School Registrar	See the Course Registration Procedure document.
Portal, login or ICT problems	DICTS service desk	support.mak.ac.ug

3. Counselling and Guidance

The Counselling and Guidance Centre helps students, and staff, who are dealing with personal or emotional challenges that could affect their studies or work. It works with other university units to help students reach their academic and personal potential.

Services offered by the Counselling and Guidance Centre:

- Individual counselling and group counselling.
- Career guidance and counselling.
- Academic support services.
- Outreach visits to halls of residence and hostels.
- Seminars and workshops for students and staff.
- Self-help print and online materials.
- Consultation with administrative offices, lecturers and staff about student welfare.

How to reach the Counselling and Guidance Centre: the Manager of Counselling and Guidance Services can be reached on +256-772-558022 (P.O. Box 7062, Kampala). The Centre's counsellor can be reached on

+256-784-107106 or +256-704-141386. The Centre's web page carries a location poster:
<https://mak.ac.ug/sites/default/files/2024-01/Counselling-and-Guidance-Centre-Poster.pdf>

Agent note: the agent shares the Centre's contact details and can offer a support ticket for a human follow-up. It does not provide counselling.

4. Health services

Makerere University Health Services (MakHS) is the name for the services offered by Makerere University Hospital, the Dental School on the main campus, and satellite clinics at the Kabanyolo and Jinja campuses. Makerere University Hospital has operated since 1978, is managed by the College of Health Sciences, and serves students, staff and the wider community.

Services listed for Makerere University Hospital:

- General outpatient services, inpatient care, and consultant-led outpatient clinics.
- Pharmacy, laboratory and diagnostic radiology services.
- HIV care and immunization services.
- Dental services (at the Dental Hospital on the main campus), ENT, optometry and ophthalmology.
- Sports medicine and physiotherapy, clinical nurse specialists, and surgical services.
- Ambulance and evacuation services.

Where and how to reach Makerere University Hospital: Bativa Road, just off Gaddafi Road as you branch off Makerere Hill Road, Kampala. Telephone: +256-414-541577 or +256-414-542922. Service details: hospital.mak.ac.ug/services. The university page encourages consultations by appointment with the relevant specialist.

Agent note: the agent does not diagnose or give medical advice. In an emergency it points the student to the hospital's ambulance service and the university's emergency contacts page (<https://mak.ac.ug/emergency-contact>).

5. Accommodation

Halls of residence. Makerere University has nine halls of residence for undergraduates on the main campus. Six are for men: Lumumba, Livingstone, Mitchell, Nkrumah, Nsibirwa and University Hall. Three are for women: Africa, Complex (CCE) and Mary Stuart. Together the halls house about 4,400 students, roughly 10% of the undergraduate population.

Hall of attachment is not the same as a bed space. Every admitted student is attached to a hall as part of their identity at the university, but this does not automatically give them accommodation. Bed space is limited, and a student is only resident once both the Office of the Dean of Students and the hall Warden have confirmed it.

First-year places. A limited number of places is announced each year for government-sponsored students from selected degree programmes and for students with disabilities. Privately sponsored students must apply and obtain authorization from the Dean of Students to become residents.

Who is not eligible for hall accommodation:

- Students admitted through the Diploma and Mature Age Entry schemes. The exception is fifth-year medical students, who may live in Galloway Hostel.
- Students on External or Distance degree programmes, except during face-to-face sessions.

Other university hostels. Galloway Hostel at Mulago houses continuing undergraduates from the College of Health Sciences. Kabanyolo Hostel houses continuing students from the College of Agricultural and Environmental Sciences. The Dag Hammarskjöld Postgraduate Hall is the hall of attachment for all postgraduate students of Makerere and its affiliated institutions (MUBS, Nsamizi and Kinyamasika Seminary).

Students without a hall place. Government-sponsored students who live off campus are paid a Living-Out Allowance (LOA). Privately sponsored students who live off campus are supported by their sponsors. Students who do not get on-campus accommodation can report to the Office of the Dean of Students to be placed in a university-affiliated hostel or another hostel.

Privately owned hostels. Many students live in private hostels, most within about half a kilometre of campus, and many run shuttles to campus. The university's Policy on Students' Accommodation governs how it works with hostel owners, and a Hostel Inspection Committee inspects accredited and affiliated hostels. Hostels are grouped as Mixed or Female and graded A (Excellent), B (Very Good) or C (Good) from the committee's latest review.

Grade	Hostels (M = mixed, F = female)
A (Excellent)	Braetd Hostel (F), JJ Hostel (M), Lady Juliana (F), Makerere Garden Courts (F), Nakiyingi (M), New Nana (M), Olympia Hostel (M)
B (Very Good)	Akwata Empola (M), Apex (F), Aryan (M), Dream World Hostel (M), Edith Hetty (F), Kann Hostel (M), Kare Hostel (M), Makerere International Students' Hostel (M), Muhika (M), Nalika (M), Pearl View (M), St. Monica (M), Sunway (M), Zoa Hostel (M)
C (Good)	Baskon Hostel (M), Bbira (F), Castle Ville (M), Cheds (M), Douglas Villa (M), Herican (M), Messiah (M), Prince (M), Waveney Courts (M)

The 2023 hostel inspection report is at <https://mak.ac.ug/sites/default/files/2024-03/Hostel-Inspection-Report-2023.pdf>

Contact: Office of the Dean of Students, Senate Building, Room 208. Telephone as printed on the university page: +256 (414) 456-78 90. Website: <https://dos.mak.ac.ug>

6. Catering and meals

The university's catering is provided through six food courts, in the kitchens and dining halls of Africa Hall, Nkrumah and Nsibirwa Halls, University Hall, Mary Stuart Hall, Galloway House and Kabanyolo Hostel. The service providers serve students and other members of the university community, on a cash basis or as agreed between the provider and the customer. All students can eat at the food courts, whatever their admission category.

Rules and tips that apply to students:

- Cooking is not allowed in halls of residence under the University Students Regulations, so resident students are advised to pay for meals at the food court nearest their hall.
- Government-sponsored students should register with their hall of attachment as soon as they arrive on campus, so that allowances can be processed quickly, and should bring some money for meals in the meantime.
- The university page says plans are under way to pay allowances directly to government-sponsored students.

7. Campus safety and security

Makerere University has a police station on campus. Uganda Police Force officers patrol the campus and work with the university's Campus Security staff to keep order and to run security checks at campus and building entrances. The Chief Security Officer reports to the Deputy Vice Chancellor (Finance and Administration).

Safety advice published by the university, in brief:

- Report crimes to the police and cooperate with officers who need information from you.
- Do not keep large sums of money or valuables such as laptops where they are not secure, and do not leave valuables in parked vehicles.
- Do not let strangers into your residence.

- Avoid walking alone in dark places at night, and avoid transport that already carries other passengers you do not know.
- Be wary of people who promise to fix admissions, registration, examination or graduation problems for money. The university warns that these are scams.
- Do not take part in or organise unlawful strikes, demonstrations or riots, which can lead to arrest or dismissal.

Contacts: Chief Security Officer, +256-772-329956. Officer in Charge (OC) Station, Makerere University Police, +256-782-151656.

8. Other student services

The university describes the following services on other web pages. This overview does not summarise them, so the agent should point students to the page or to the responsible office.

Service	Where to find it
Students' Guild (student representation)	https://mak.ac.ug/students/students-guild
Religion and spirituality	https://mak.ac.ug/students/religion-spirituality
Sports and recreation	https://mak.ac.ug/students/sports-recreation
Scholarships	https://mak.ac.ug/study-mak/scholarships
Student loan schemes	https://mak.ac.ug/study-mak/student-loan-schemes
Disability Support Unit	Named by a college principal at the 2025 orientation as a service available to students. Ask the Dean of Students' office for the current contact.
Library services and ICT services	See the Library Services Guide and ICT Services Guide in this corpus.

9. When to hand over to a human

- **Crisis or safety:** if a student mentions self-harm, harm to others, abuse or immediate danger, the agent gives the Counselling and Guidance Centre and emergency contact details straight away and flags the case for a human. It does not try to handle the situation alone.
- **Decisions the agent cannot make:** hall or hostel allocation, allowances, fee amounts, waivers, discipline and admissions belong to university staff. The agent explains the process, says which office decides, and can raise a support ticket.
- **Missing information:** if the answer depends on a number, date or name that is not in this document, the agent says so and points to the source page instead of guessing.

10. Details to re-check before relying on them

- **Phone numbers.** All numbers above are as published on the university pages on the compile date. The Dean of Students number is printed in an unusual format, so confirm it before quoting it.
- **Hall capacity.** The figure of about 4,400 students and the first-year place quotas change each year.
- **Hostel grades.** The A, B and C lists come from the most recent inspection round shown on the university page and may be updated.
- **Appointment wording.** The hospital page's advice to book consultations by appointment may date from the COVID-19 period.
- **Counselling costs and confidentiality.** An older Makerere news article (2011) describes counselling as free and confidential. Confirm the current position with the Centre before stating it as fact.

- **Catering.** The list of food courts differs slightly between the current university page and older communications from the Dean of Students. This overview follows the current page.

11. Sources

All pages were read in September 2026. Nothing here is copied from a university brochure.

<https://mak.ac.ug/about/counselling-guidance>

<https://mak.ac.ug/about/hospital-health-care>

<https://mak.ac.ug/students/accommodation-student-housing>

<https://mak.ac.ug/students/catering-services>

<https://mak.ac.ug/about/campus-security>

<https://news.mak.ac.ug/2011/02/counselling-and-guidance-services/> (older article, used only for the note in section 10)

<https://news.mak.ac.ug/2025/08/cees-orientation-2025-students-tipped-on-academic-excellence-setting-goals-and-development-of-work-plans/> (Disability Support Unit mention only)